

**SOUTH CAROLINA
DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES**

COMMUNITY LONG TERM CARE DIVISION

DISASTER PREPAREDNESS MANUAL

YEAR 2017

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8. Insert page listing all Emergency Management Agencies in each county served by the Regional CLTC Office.
Information must include the County, Director's Name, address, phone number, and fax number.
9. Print Regional Office Red Cross Chapters
10. Insert page listing all Red Cross Chapters in each county served by the Regional CLTC Office. Information must include the Chapter Name, address, phone number and fax number
11. Print Office Emergency Protocol
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INTRODUCTION

Community Long Term Care recognizes that the elderly and disabled population served by our waiver programs is particularly vulnerable and at risk in emergencies and disaster situations. Given this recognition, it is imperative that policies be adopted and implemented to more adequately address how to plan for and address the needs of this special population before, during, and after disasters.

Our goals in this effort include:

1. To provide information to the participants we serve to better prepare for disasters.
2. To identify the participants most at risk.
3. To coordinate with local emergency preparedness organizations, health and human services agencies and service providers.
4. To develop a CLTC emergency plan for use in area offices.

CLTC has a genuine desire to assist our participants and our staff to be prepared and to be safe.

DEFINITIONS

According to National Archive-Guide on Emergency and Disaster Control, the following terms are defined so that staff shares the same understanding and a common terminology:

1. Disaster: an incident or calamity caused by accident, natural causes or deliberate intent and resulting in:
 - A. Serious damage or destruction to records and facilities;
 - B. A sudden threat to personal safety; or
 - C. Major disruption of operations
2. Emergency: an abnormal situation, present or imminent, which requires prompt action or special regulation of persons or property to protect the health, safety or well-being of people or to limit damage to records or property.

DEFINITION OF PARTICIPANT-AT-RISK

Participant-at-risk list includes: participants who live alone, participants with advanced medical needs (ventilator, dialysis, other special equipment) and other participants as identified.

- **Not Priority** Participant is not vulnerable during emergency/disaster or has adequate supports to meet his/her needs.
(Example: Participant with functional deficits but family willing and able to evacuate and/or meet needs.)
- **Priority Lives Alone** Participant lives alone and is vulnerable in emergency/disaster due to limitation of support system.
(Example: Participant who lives alone and has no one available to evacuate him/her or has no one to give medications.)
- **Priority Advance Medical Need** Participant has advanced medical needs and would be vulnerable during an emergency/disaster.
(Example: Participant who is on ventilator, dialysis or other specialized equipment/services.)
- **Priority other** Participant with special needs as identified by the case manager/nurse consultant who would be vulnerable during emergency/disaster.
(Example: Participant who can only be transported by ambulance.)

During a disaster, priority for CLTC action would first be to those with immediate URGENT needs impacted by the disaster or its side effects and secondly to all others identified.

CASE MANAGERS AND NURSE CONSULTANTS RESPONSIBILITIES FOR PARTICIPANT PREPAREDNESS

1. Nurse Consultant identifies participants who could be at-risk priority for emergencies/disasters during the in home initial assessment by completing the Emergency Disaster Priority Tab in Phoenix Home Assessment.
2. Case Manager identifies who could be at-risk for emergencies/disasters during the initial visit for cases when the initial assessment was completed by telephone by completing the Emergency Disaster Priority Tab in Phoenix Home Assessment.
3. Nurse Consultant completes Emergency Disaster Preparedness Tab in Phoenix Home Assessment during the in home initial assessment by completing the Emergency Disaster Preparedness Tab in Phoenix Home Assessment.
4. Case Manager identifies who could be at-risk for emergencies/disasters during the initial visit for cases when the initial assessment was completed by telephone by completing the Emergency Disaster Preparedness Tab in Phoenix Home Assessment
5. Case Manager reviews emergency/disaster priority status and emergency preparedness status of participant with participant, and/or primary contact, and/or permitted caregiver during the initial visit and at each evaluation. This status must be keyed into Phoenix with changes made to the status as needed.
6. Case Manager discusses "Emergency Preparedness Checklist" and "Emergency Telephone List" with participant, and/or primary contact or permitted caregiver during the initial visit, and as needed and leaves a copy in the home.
7. Case Manager assists participant, and/or primary contact, and/or permitted caregiver as needed to complete checklist(s) with the appropriate emergency telephone numbers.
8. Case Manager assists participant, and/or primary contact, and/or permitted caregiver as needed to identify an evacuation plan including who will meet the needs of the participant in case of emergency or disaster and where the participant will go in case of evacuation. The full name, address and phone number of the individual responsible for assisting the participant in the event of an emergency/disaster must be included in the comment section.
9. Case Manager requests permission from the participant, and/or primary contact, and/or permitted caregiver to share the name of the participant who has been identified as priority for emergencies and/or disasters with the Emergency Management Office, American Red Cross, or other emergency response agencies. This choice for notification to emergency agencies must be keyed into Phoenix.

10. Case Manager reviews Emergency/Disaster Priority Status with participant, and/or primary contact, and/or permitted caregiver as necessary and at least during the initial visit, each quarterly visit and each reevaluation visit.
11. Service planning must address the special needs of the participant who would be vulnerable during an emergency and/or disaster.
12. The Case Manager is responsible for initiating Emergency/Disaster Protocol in the event of an imminent disaster or notification of a participant emergency.
13. The Case Manager is responsible for completing the pre-disaster checklist and post-disaster checklist in Phoenix. These checklists will be used to document and report pre-disaster and post-disaster efforts when an emergency or disaster is imminent and the Emergency/Disaster Plan has been implemented by Central Office or the Area Office.

PARTICIPANTS-AT-RISK PROTOCOL FOR IMMINENT EMERGENCY/DISASTER

1. Case Managers and Nurse Consultants will synchronize their laptop.
2. Case Managers and Nurse Consultants will utilize the Phoenix report "My Service Manager Roster" to identify at-risk participants.
3. If possible, Case Managers and Nurse Consultants will make initial contact with at-risk participants, the primary contact, or permitted care giver before the emergency/disaster to ensure they are aware of the situation and have an appropriate plan.
4. For at-risk participants who do not have an appropriate plan and have given permission for their name to be released, Case Managers and Nurse Consultants will contact providers and/or appropriate agencies (e.g. Emergency Management Office, American Red Cross), to share the participant's name and appropriate information.
5. As soon as possible after the emergency/disaster, Case Managers and Nurse Consultants will contact participants to learn of their status and provide assistance as needed.
6. As soon as possible after the emergency/disaster, Area Administrator will notify Central Office of the Regional Office status and needs.

**REGIONAL OFFICE EMERGENCY
MANAGEMENT AGENCIES**

**REGIONAL OFFICE RED CROSS
CHAPTERS**

OFFICE EMERGENCY PROTOCOL

ITEM	ACTION	COMPLETED
1	Call emergency office staff meeting	
2	Review the Office Emergency Protocol steps	
3	Activate the simultaneous protocol steps	
	Support Staff: Secure office records and objects	
	Secure equipment/furniture as appropriate for disaster type	
	If feasible, synchronize laptops	
	Assist others as needed	
	Case Managers: Secure participant-at-risk list	
	Initiate the participant-at-risk protocol	
	Team staff major problems	
	Assist others as needed	
	Nurse Consultants: Secure participant-at-risk list	
	Initiate the participant-at-risk protocol	
	Team staff major problems	
	Assist others as needed	
	Area Administrator: Contact Central Office, Emergency Preparedness Office (and possibly landlord)	
	Secure safe haven for office headquarters if office must be evacuated	
	Provide general supervision of emergency operations and act as staff resource	
	Monitor radio for Emergency Preparedness directives	

IF TRAVEL TO THE OFFICE IS RESTRICTED AND DISASTER IS IMMINENT:

1. CONTACT YOUR SUPERVISOR BY PHONE
2. LEAD TEAM CHECK-IN WITH AREA ADMINISTRATOR
3. AREA ADMINISTRATOR WILL HAVE ALTERNATE PLAN IN PLACE TO ENSURE APPROPRIATE ITEMS.
4. WHEN TRAVEL TO THE OFFICE IS CLEARED, OFFICE DESIGNEE SHOULD DETERMINE STATUS OF OFFICE AND ADVISE OTHERS AS APPROPRIATE. CALL FORWARD AS APPROPRIATE.

IF THE TELEPHONES ARE NOT OPERATIONAL BUT TRAVEL IS POSSIBLE:

1. SIGN-IN/OUT AT DESIGNATED COMMAND COMMUNICATION POST.
2. COMPLETE APPROPRIATE STEPS OF THE OFFICE EMERGENCY PROTOCOL AS ABOVE.

IF THE DISASTER OCCURS WITHOUT WARNING (I.E. EARTHQUAKE, TORNADO) FOLLOW EVACUATION PLAN AND PROCEED WITH POST-DISASTER PROTOCOL FOR EFFECTED AREA WHEN PERMISSIBLE.

Follow emergency preparedness office/local authority directives and observe personal safety steps.

REGIONAL OFFICE POST DISASTER PROTOCOL

WHO	ACTION	COMPLETED
AREA ADMINISTRATOR	• As soon as possible, assess any damage to area office(s) and secure alternate safe haven for operations as needed. (See Post-Disaster Assessment and Employee Status.) • Assess state staff status and availability for office operations. • Assess contract case managers' status and availability for office operations. • Report office and operations status to Central Office requesting coverage assistance as needed. Contact Buddy Office as need. (See Buddy Office Listing.) • Report status to local authorities as appropriate coordinating as appropriate with local Emergency Management office and FEMA. • Contact local waiver providers for status of service delivery. • Provide general supervision of post-disaster operations and act as staff resource.	
SUPPORT STAFF	• Secure office records and objects notifying Area Administrator of any damage/loss. • Secure equipment/furniture as appropriate notifying Area Administrator of damage/loss. • Notify BITS Helpdesk at 803-898-2575 as needed for network/server assistance. • Assist others as needed.	
CASE MANAGERS/ NURSE CONSULTANTS	• Beginning with participant-at-risk list, contact and locate all participants and/or primary contacts or permitted caregivers identifying status and service needs. • Complete service coordination with other entities as appropriate for identified participant needs. Advise participant/primary caregiver or permitted caregiver as appropriate or possible assistance from FEMA. As appropriate, make referrals to the CLTC participant fund. • Keep Lead Team informed of progress and advise of additional assistance needed. • Assist others as needed.	

IF TRAVEL TO THE OFFICE IS RESTRICTED:

1. CONTACT YOUR SUPERVISOR BY PHONE
2. LEAD TEAM CHECK-IN WITH AREA ADMINISTRATOR
3. AREA ADMINISTRATOR NOTIFY CENTRAL OFFICE OF STATUS AND COVERAGE ASSISTANCE NEEDED
4. WHEN TRAVEL TO THE OFFICE IS CLEARED, OFFICE DESIGNEE SHOULD DETERMINE STATUS OF OFFICE AND ADVISES OTHERS AS APPROPRIATE. EMPLOYEES SHOULD REPORT BACK TO WORK AS SOON AS POSSIBLE.

IF THE TELEPHONES ARE NOT OPERATIONAL BUT TRAVEL IS POSSIBLE:

1. SIGN-OUT AT DESIGNATED COMMAND COMMUNICATION POST
2. COMPLETE APPROPRIATE STEPS OF THE POST DISASTER PROTOCOL ABOVE.

FOLLOW LOCAL AUTHORITY AND OBSERVE PERSONAL SAFETY.

POST-DISASTER OFFICE ASSESSMENT

ITEM	OK	PROBLEM
CEILING		
COMPUTER		
EQUIPMENT		
FILES		
FLOORS		
FURNITURE		
HEATING COOLING		
POWER		
PROPERTY: EXTERNAL		
ROOF		
SERVERS		
SEWERAGE		
STATE VEHICLE		
SUPPLIES		
TELEPHONES		
WALLS: INTERIOR		
WALLS: EXTERIOR		
WATER		
WINDOWS		
OTHER		

POST-DISASTER STATE STAFF/CONTRACT CASE MANAGER STATUS

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